

Photograph by BANDEEP SINGH

Roshni Nadar Malhotra, *42*
Chairperson, HCLTech

MONEY MATTERS

"Be financially independent and as financially literate as you can be"

↘ **IN THE BOWL** **Not a foodie, but does love good Japanese food, especially sushi**

↘ **BRICK WORK** **Unwinds by working on giant 10,000-piece Lego block structures**

Digital Transformer

ROSHNI NADAR MALHOTRA IS ELATED. Her father had always advised the HCL Technologies chairperson to "stay the course". That seems to be paying off: HCLTech has achieved a significant milestone with total revenues hitting Rs 1.01 lakh crore for FY23, a year-on-year growth of 18.5 per cent. The company also recently closed a mega deal worth $2.1 billion (Rs 17,508 crore) with US-based Verizon Business for managed network services (MNS). Additionally, in Europe, the company won a contract from German technology giant Siemens AG to modernise its cloud-led digital transformation. "When discretionary spending slows down, mega deals like these present themselves. This growth is driven by our strategy of leading through differentiated products and services," says Roshni. A key initiative that has worked for them was the acquisition of IBM Software Products in 2018. Now HCL Software, its annual recurring revenue crossed $1 billion (Rs 8,300 crore) in FY23. "We have recovered the entire investment," she says.

The growth extends beyond the business to stakeholders too. Over the past four years, HCLTech has delivered total shareholder return at a CAGR of 22.2 per cent per annum, which the company claims is the highest among its peers. However, Roshni, who is a mother to two sons, expresses concern for fresh graduates, as IT firms, including hers, slow down hiring to increase margins. "I can say this because I am an employer and also a provider of talent," she says. So, is it a challenge to balance the company's pursuit of increased profitability with the maximum impact motto of the HCL Foundation (the company's CSR arm)? "It's not an either/or, just a matter of taking each day as it comes," she says.

Roshni devotes 30 per cent of her time fixing strategy for the company's philanthropic initiatives, such as the rural leadership academy for gifted students VidyaGyan and wildlife conservation organisation, The Habitats Trust. "HCLTech was established 25 years ago, so the systems and processes are mature. Everything else is just 12 years old, so they are more in a start-up mode and need a little more handholding," she explains. ■

–Sonal Khetarpal

ACCOMPLISHMENT

Despite reports of a global slowdown, India's third largest IT giant HCLTech reported y-on-y growth of 18.5%